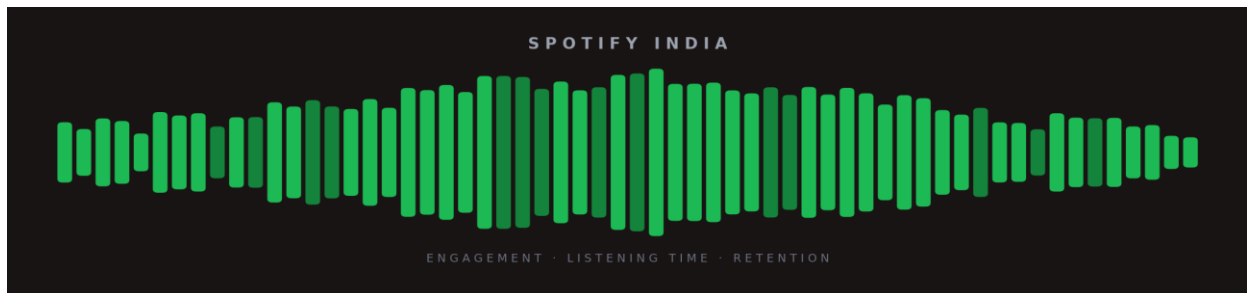


# BUSINESS REQUIREMENTS DOCUMENT

## Increasing User Engagement and Listening Time for Spotify India



Project Code: BAF-13

Prepared By: Shivika Agrawal

Date: 26-07-2026

## Document Control

| Field          | Details                                                                                                                                                                                    |
|----------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Project Title  | Increasing User Engagement and Listening Time for Spotify India                                                                                                                            |
| Document Type  | Business Requirements Document (BRD)                                                                                                                                                       |
| Prepared By    | Shivika Agrawal                                                                                                                                                                            |
| Version / Date | 26/07/2026                                                                                                                                                                                 |
| Purpose        | Defines WHAT problem is being solved, WHY it matters, WHAT the business expects, and HOW success will be measured. It does not specify how the engineering team should build the solution. |

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## 1. Executive Summary Snapshot

**Purpose.** This BRD defines the problem of low user engagement and insufficient time spent listening on Spotify India. It gives product, design, engineering, data, and strategy teams shared context on what needs to be solved and why.

Spotify is one of the world's leading music streaming platforms, yet Indian users spend less time listening than users of competing platforms such as YouTube Music, JioSaavn, and (historically) Gaana. India is uniquely challenging: free content is abundant, listening tastes span 10+ major languages, and users are highly price- and data-sensitive. The competitive field has also consolidated — Wynk Music shut down and migrated users to Apple Music, and Gaana moved to a paid-only model — making engagement depth the decisive battleground.

### THE PROBLEM IN ONE LINE

Indian users average an estimated 35 listening minutes per day (assumed project baseline) versus 60+ minutes in Spotify's mature markets. Sessions are short (~18 min), skip rates are high (~30%), and free users frequently exit after ads — capping ad revenue, Premium conversion, and retention.

This project identifies the key factors that reduce listening time and defines the requirements for increasing engagement, session duration, and long-term retention. Increasing listening time directly improves business performance by:

- Increasing ad impressions served to Free-tier users
- Improving Free-to-Premium subscription conversion (target: 4% → 6%)
- Increasing 30-day customer retention (target: 58% → 68%)
- Improving Average Revenue Per User (ARPU) and Customer Lifetime Value (LTV)
- Strengthening Spotify's market position in India

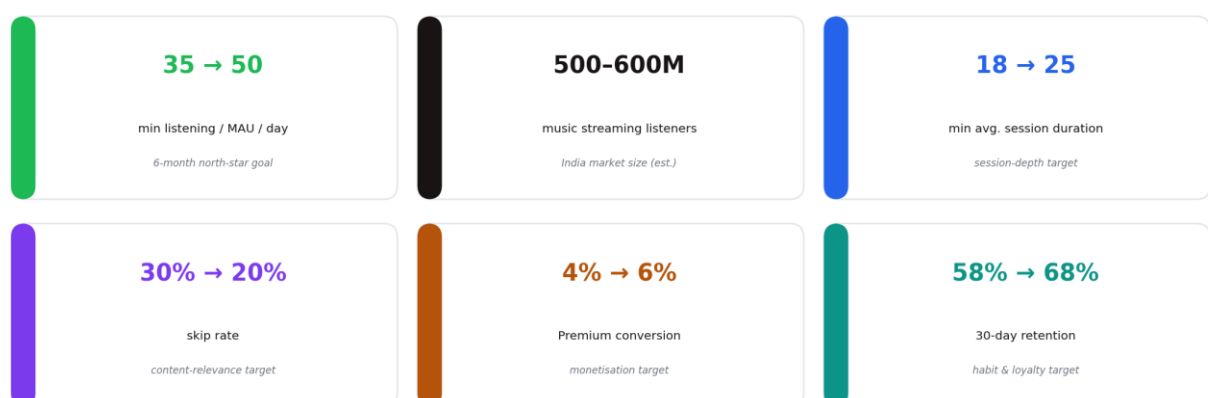


Figure 1 — Project at a glance: the six numbers this initiative exists to move.

## 2. Project Description

Spotify's recommendation engine performs exceptionally well globally, but Indian users exhibit different listening behaviours: mobile-first Android usage on budget devices, film-music-anchored

and rapidly regionalising tastes, single-song search intent shaped by years of YouTube, and prepaid data budgeting that makes streaming feel financially risky. Major challenges observed in Milestone 1 research include:

- High demand for regional-language music (Punjabi, Tamil, Telugu, Bhojpuri, Marathi, Bengali) that current onboarding under-serves
- Short listening sessions concentrated in commute and chore windows, easily cut off by interruptions and weak networks
- Free users abandoning sessions after advertisements and skip-limit friction
- Low discovery of playlists and podcasts; repetitive recommendations that drift from the user's language and context
- Heavy competition from bundled and free alternatives (JioSaavn via telecom bundles, YouTube Music via the video graph)

**Objective.** Redesign the engagement experience — onboarding, personalisation, content discovery, and retention — so that every app open converts into a longer, more satisfying, habit-forming listening session.

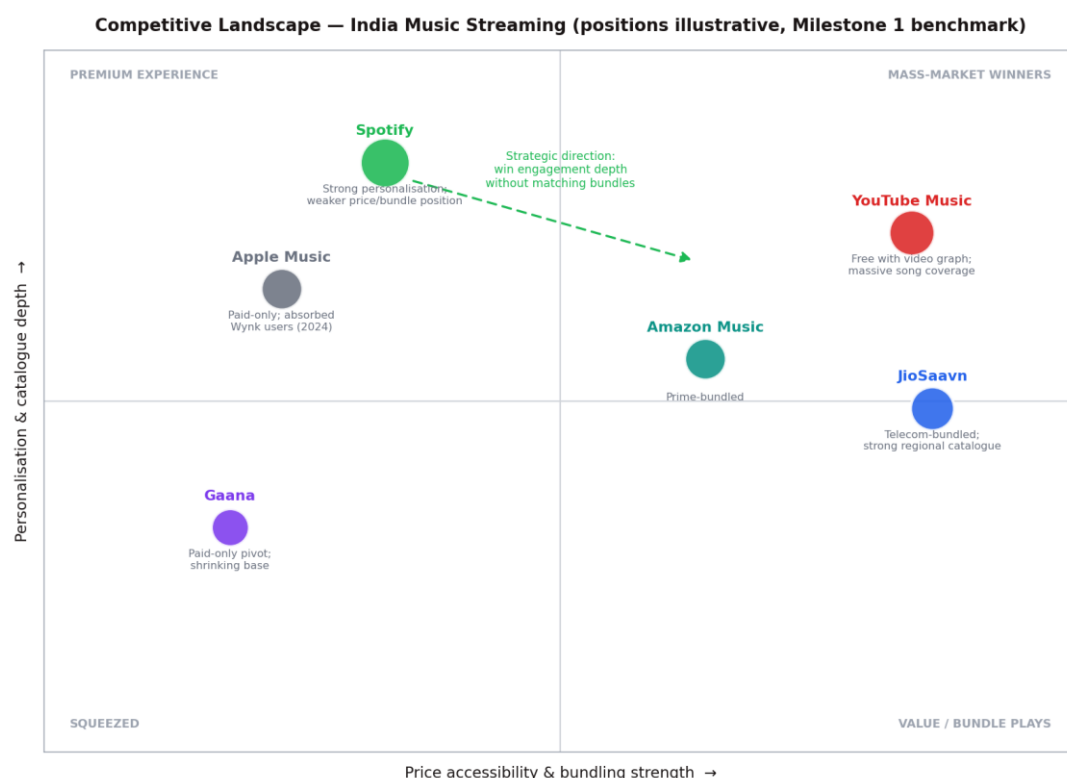


Figure 2 — Competitive landscape. Spotify leads on personalisation depth but cannot match telecom/commerce bundles — engagement depth is the winnable axis.

## 3. Project Scope

### 3.1 In Scope

| #  | Scope Item                                                                                       |
|----|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1  | Analyse user listening behaviour in India across Free and Premium tiers                          |
| 2  | Measure listening time across user segments (language, city tier, age, device, plan)             |
| 3  | Analyse playlist completion rates and skip behaviour                                             |
| 4  | Identify session drop-off points in the engagement funnel                                        |
| 5  | Benchmark competitor engagement models (YouTube Music, JioSaavn, Amazon Music, Apple Music)      |
| 6  | Analyse recommendation effectiveness and language match                                          |
| 7  | Analyse onboarding as a source of the first-play relevance gap (problem diagnosis, not redesign) |
| 8  | Define engagement KPIs and build the KPI tree                                                    |
| 9  | User journey mapping (current vs proposed)                                                       |
| 10 | Dashboard design for engagement metrics                                                          |

### 3.2 Out of Scope

| # | Exclusion                                                      | Reason                                                       |
|---|----------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1 | Global Spotify markets                                         | India-specific initiative                                    |
| 2 | Music licensing negotiations (e.g., Bollywood catalogue deals) | Owned by Content & Licensing                                 |
| 3 | Infrastructure redesign / audio streaming technology changes   | No platform re-architecture budgeted                         |
| 4 | Backend recommendation algorithm development                   | Engineering solution detail, not business requirement        |
| 5 | Marketing campaign execution                                   | Owned by Marketing; this BRD only defines engagement targets |

#### SCOPE EXAMPLE

In scope: tracking listening session lengths, analysing playlist completion, reviewing competitor engagement models. Out of scope: negotiating Bollywood catalogue deals, redesigning the global recommendation engine.

## 4. Business Drivers

### 4.1 Strategic Drivers

- India has an estimated 500–600 million music streaming listeners (industry reports), making it one of Spotify's largest and fastest-growing user bases — but one of its lowest-ARPU markets.

- Engagement depth is the defensible moat: with rivals bundled into telecom and commerce ecosystems, users stay only where listening feels effortless and personal.
- Short-video platforms (Reels, Shorts) compete for the same commute and leisure minutes; audio must win those minutes back.

## 4.2 Commercial Drivers

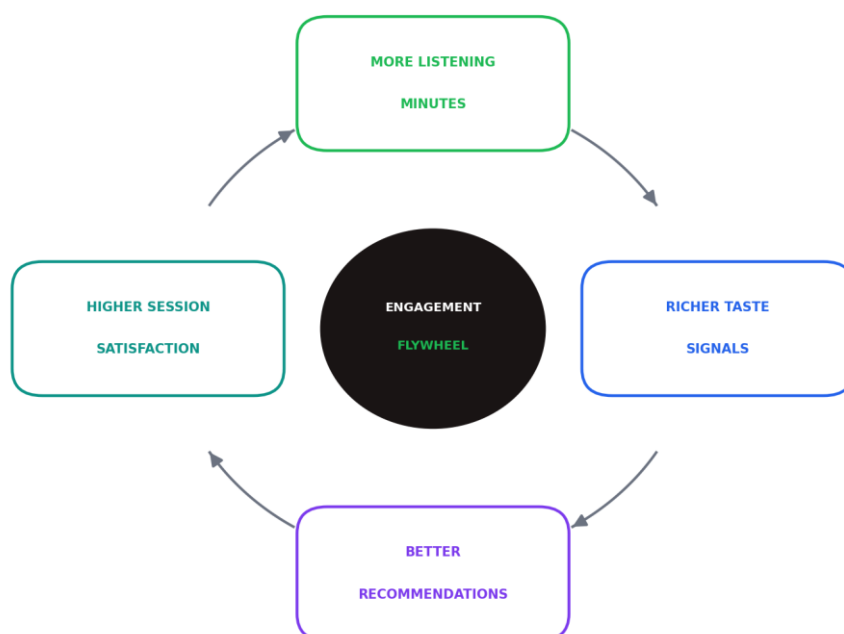
Longer listening time leads directly to:

- More advertisements served per Free user (listening minutes are ad inventory)
- Higher Premium subscriptions — engaged users convert at multiples of light users
- Increased Average Revenue Per User (ARPU)
- Higher Lifetime Value (LTV) and lower effective acquisition cost, since retention protects past marketing spend

## 4.3 Operational Drivers

- A standardised engagement dashboard enables Product, Marketing, Analytics, and Engineering to monitor performance consistently.
- Segment-level measurement (FR-1 to FR-10) localises exactly where listening time is lost, replacing intuition with evidence.
- Personalisation flywheel: more engaged minutes generate richer signals, which improve recommendations, which further lift engagement.

**The Engagement Flywheel — Why Listening Minutes Compound**



*Short sessions starve the models and reverse the flywheel — the failure mode this project exists to prevent.*

*Figure 3 — The engagement flywheel: every incremental listening minute compounds through better signals and recommendations.*

## 5. Current Process

### 5.1 Existing User Journey

1. User installs Spotify and creates an account.
2. Onboarding asks for favourite artists only — language preference is not captured.
3. Home page displays recommendations skewed to Bollywood/English defaults.
4. User begins listening; relevance is hit-or-miss for regional-first users.
5. Advertisements interrupt Free users; skip limits add friction.
6. Users skip repeatedly, grow frustrated, or hit the skip cap.
7. Session ends early — often within minutes — and the user switches to YouTube Music or Reels.

**USER JOURNEY — Current vs Proposed Engagement Flow**

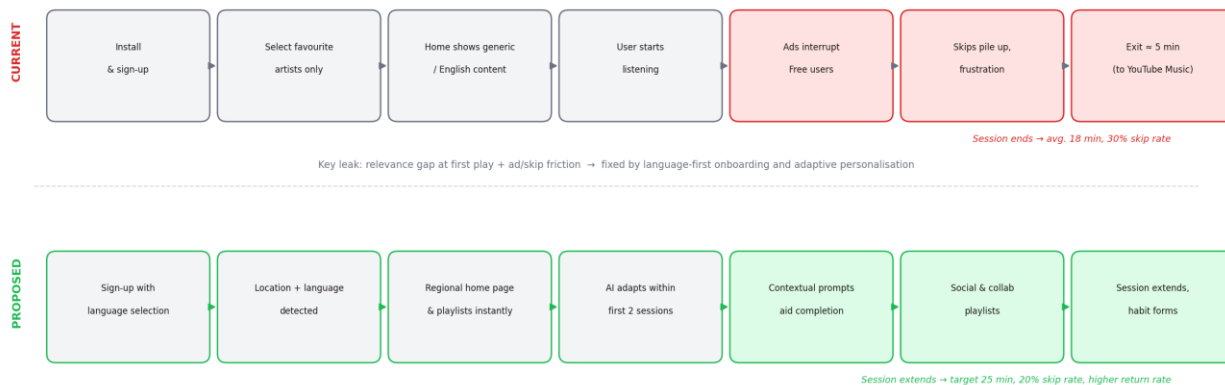


Figure 4 — Current engagement journey (top) vs proposed journey (bottom). The relevance gap at first play plus ad/skip friction is the primary leak.

### 5.2 Engagement Funnel — Where Sessions Are Lost

**Daily Engagement Funnel — Where Listening Time Is Lost (illustrative baseline, to be validated Week 5)**

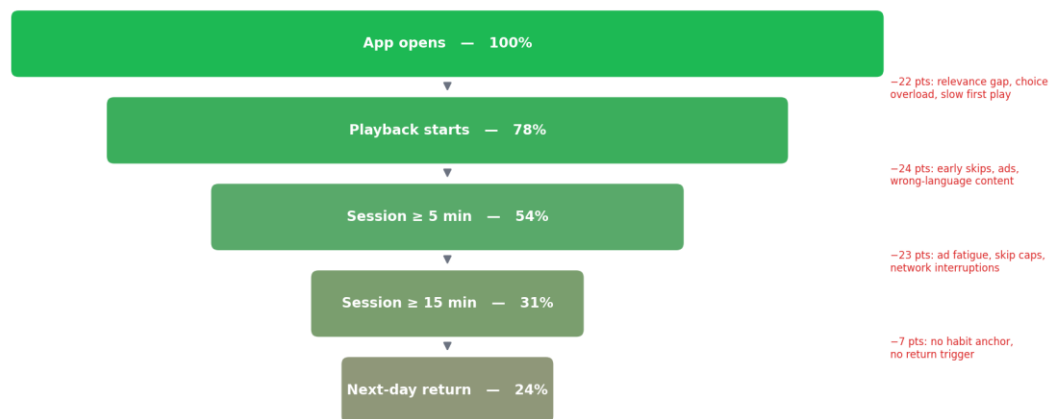


Figure 5 — Illustrative daily engagement funnel with leak causes at each stage; Week-5 analytics will replace these with production values.

### 5.3 Pain Points

| Pain Point                                         | Impact on Listening Time                                                                     |
|----------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Limited regional personalisation during onboarding | Regional-first users see irrelevant content at first play; many exit before a session starts |
| Repetitive recommendations                         | Users exhaust interest quickly; sessions shorten; app feels stale                            |
| Poor discovery of new playlists & podcasts         | Users default to the same few playlists; catalogue depth goes unused                         |
| Advertisement fatigue (Free tier)                  | Ads are the most common session-exit trigger for Free users                                  |
| Skip limitations frustrate users                   | Skip-cap hits correlate with immediate session abandonment                                   |
| Context-aware recommendations are limited          | Commute, study, and chore moments are not matched, so habit anchors never form               |
| Shared devices / accounts in family households     | Mixed taste signals degrade personalisation quality for everyone on the profile              |

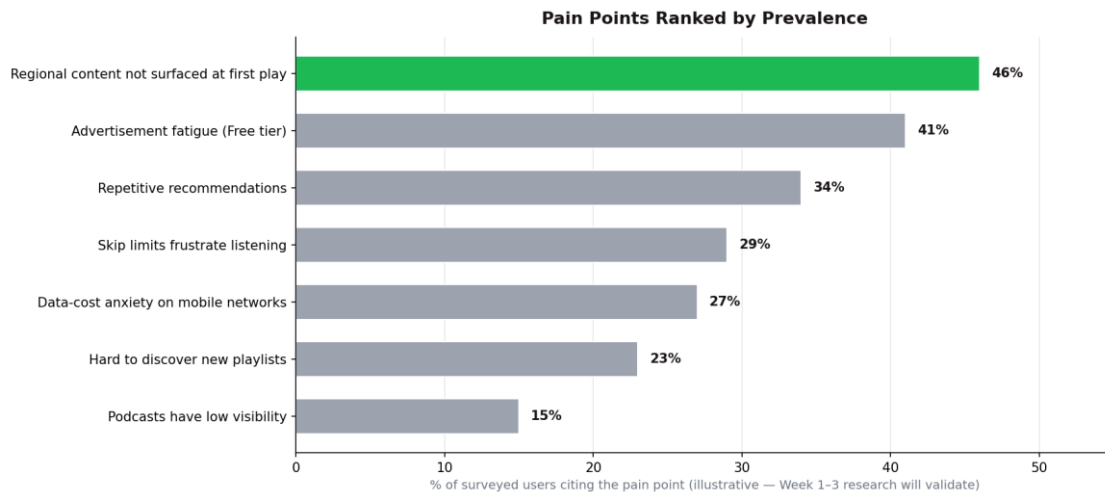


Figure 6 — Pain points ranked by prevalence (illustrative; validated in Weeks 1–3 research). Regional relevance is the single biggest lever.

### REAL-WORLD EXAMPLE

A Telugu-speaking user signs up and receives Bollywood and English recommendations instead of Telugu music. After skipping several songs and encountering ads, the user leaves within five minutes and returns to YouTube Music — where the exact song they wanted plays instantly, free, with video.

## 6. Proposed Process — Framing the Problem

**Note on intent.** This section reframes the challenge as a shared, evidence-based problem definition — it deliberately does not prescribe features, journeys, or solutions. It defines what the target experience must achieve and how we will discover the answers, leaving the *how* to the solution phase.

### 6.1 Reframing the As-Is Into Problem Statements

Instead of proposing a new journey, we restate each current-state failure (Section 5) as a neutral problem to be solved. Every downstream team works from this shared list:

| Current-state failure                   | Reframed problem statement (to be solved, not yet how)                                                   |
|-----------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Language not captured at onboarding     | Users are not reliably matched to relevant content at first play, especially regional-language listeners |
| Generic / repetitive recommendations    | Personalisation does not sustain interest deep enough into a session across Indian segments              |
| Ads & skip caps trigger exits           | Free-tier friction interrupts intent before a listening habit can form                                   |
| Sessions cut by network / interruptions | Sessions do not survive real Indian usage conditions (weak networks, calls, data limits)                 |
| Event-driven, occasional usage          | Occasional listening has not converted into a daily habit around stable contexts                         |

| Current-state failure      | Reframed problem statement (to be solved, not yet how)                          |
|----------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Search-and-leave behaviour | Single-song intent is not understood well enough to extend into longer sessions |

## 6.2 Design Thinking — 'How Might We' Framing

Applying design-thinking discipline, each problem cluster is expressed as an open 'How Might We' (HMW) question. HMW questions invite many possible solutions without pre-selecting one — the correct altitude for a BRD.

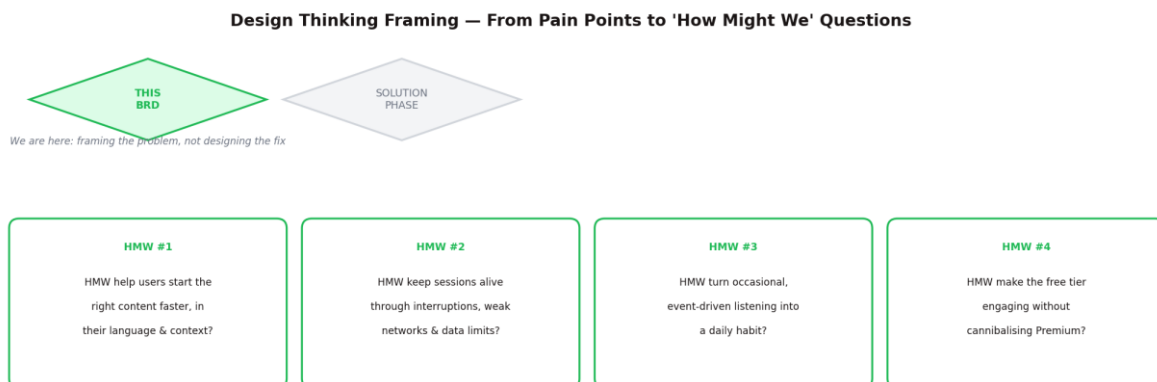


Figure 7 — Design-thinking framing. This BRD sits in the Discover/Define space; HMW questions open the problem without prescribing the fix.

## 6.3 Jobs-to-be-Done (JTBD)

The JTBD framework reframes demand around the 'job' a user hires the product to accomplish, independent of any feature. It keeps the team focused on user progress rather than on solution ideas. Four core jobs emerged from Milestone 1 research:

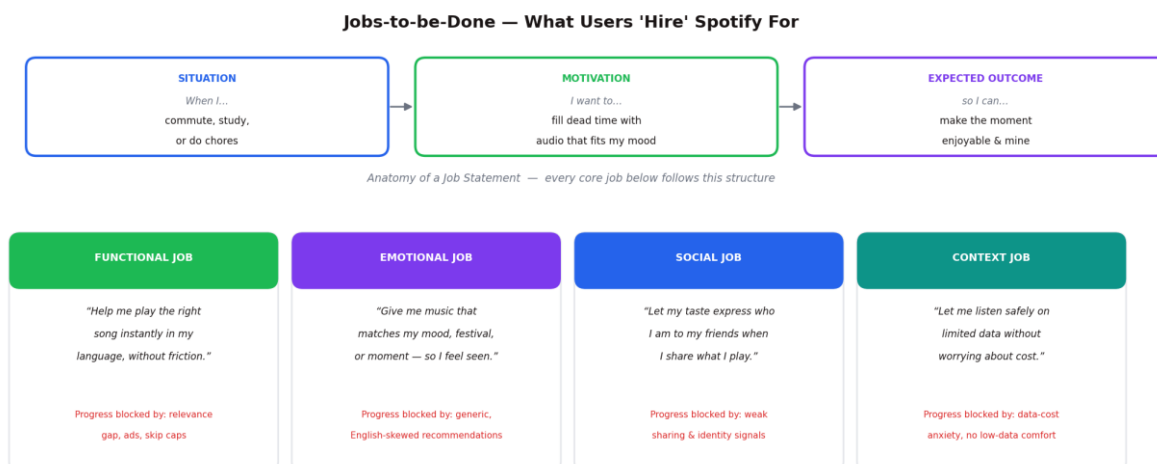


Figure 8 — Core functional, emotional, social, and context jobs, each with the progress currently blocking the user.

**Job-statement format used throughout:** “When I [situation], I want to [motivation], so I can [expected outcome].”

## 6.4 Product Discovery Plan

Rather than jumping to build, we define how the problem will be validated. A dual-track discovery approach pairs qualitative depth (why engagement breaks) with quantitative breadth (how widespread each barrier is), producing a ranked problem backlog.

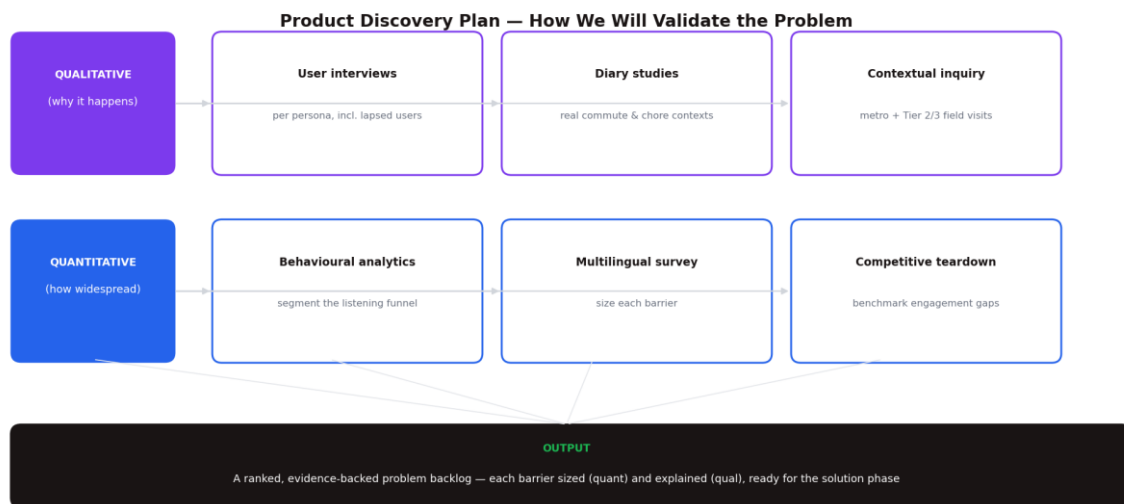


Figure 9 — Dual-track discovery: qualitative methods explain the 'why', quantitative methods size the 'how widespread', converging on a validated problem backlog.

## 6.5 Framing Outcomes as Problems to Close (Not Solutions)

The target end-state is expressed purely as measurable gaps to close — the metric movement defines success without dictating the mechanism:

| Problem to close          | Gap (current → target)     | Success is when...                                            |
|---------------------------|----------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------|
| Sessions end too early    | 18 → 25 min                | Users stay engaged longer per session, by any validated means |
| Content abandoned mid-way | Completion 52% → 70%       | Users finish more of what they start                          |
| Poor content match        | Skip rate 30% → 20%        | Fewer early skips signal better relevance                     |
| Users don't return        | 30-day retention 58% → 68% | A daily habit forms                                           |
| Low willingness to pay    | Premium conversion 4% → 6% | Engagement precedes conversion                                |
| Overall under-listening   | 35 → 50 min / MAU / day    | The north-star gap closes                                     |

## 7. Functional Requirements

A functional requirement defines **what the system should do**. Priorities: Critical / High / Medium.

| ID    | Requirement                                                | Why It Matters                                                                    | Priority |
|-------|------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------|
| FR-1  | Track listening minutes per user                           | Primary KPI; the metric this whole project moves                                  | Critical |
| FR-2  | Measure session duration                                   | Distinguishes many short sessions from fewer long ones                            | Critical |
| FR-3  | Detect session drop-off points                             | Localises exactly where and why sessions end (ads, skips, network, interruptions) | Critical |
| FR-4  | Track playlist completion rate                             | Completion signals satisfaction; abandonment signals relevance gaps               | High     |
| FR-5  | Track skip behaviour (incl. skips within first 30 seconds) | Early skips are the clearest signal of poor content match                         | High     |
| FR-6  | Segment users by language                                  | Regional relevance is the #1 engagement lever in India                            | High     |
| FR-7  | Segment users by device and network class                  | Budget Android + weak networks shape what sessions can survive                    | Medium   |
| FR-8  | Measure cross-device listening                             | Understands continuity of habit across phone, desktop, and speaker                | Medium   |
| FR-9  | Track recommendation acceptance rate                       | Measures whether personalisation is actually working per segment                  | High     |
| FR-10 | Measure podcast engagement                                 | Podcasts extend commute sessions; visibility today is low                         | Medium   |
| FR-11 | Capture language preference during onboarding              | Closes the relevance gap at first play for regional users                         | Critical |
| FR-12 | Support A/B experimentation with segment-level guardrails  | Every engagement change must be validated causally before rollout                 | High     |

## 8. Non-Functional Requirements

*A non-functional requirement defines **how well the system performs**.*

| Requirement     | Description                                                                                         |
|-----------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Scalability     | Support 100+ million daily listening sessions, including festival and cricket-season traffic spikes |
| Availability    | 99.9% uptime for playback and engagement tracking                                                   |
| Performance     | Engagement dashboards refresh within 24 hours; app remains smooth on low-RAM Android devices        |
| Data efficiency | No engagement initiative may materially raise default data consumption for prepaid-data users       |

| Requirement        | Description                                                                                                       |
|--------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Security & Privacy | GDPR and Indian DPDP Act (2023) compliance; consent-based behavioural tracking; encryption in transit and at rest |
| Accessibility      | Dashboards usable by non-technical business users; app experience supports major Indian languages and scripts     |
| Reliability        | Less than 1% data loss in analytics pipelines                                                                     |
| Maintainability    | Modular reporting pipelines so new KPIs can be added without rework                                               |
| Ethical engagement | No dark patterns; increased time spent must reflect genuine user value (guardrails in Section 10)                 |

## 9. Assumptions and Constraints

### 9.1 Assumptions

- **A1:** Better recommendations increase listening time (engagement gap is relevance-driven, not interest-driven).
- **A2:** Regional content drives engagement — the largest headroom lies in regional-language and Tier 2/3 segments.
- **A3:** Personalised, language-first onboarding improves early retention (Week-1 and Week-4).
- **A4:** Free users tolerate ads if recommendations remain relevant; relevance, not ad load alone, decides exits.
- **A5:** Baseline figures used in this BRD (35 min/day, 30% skip rate, etc.) are assumed for project planning and will be validated against production analytics in Week 5.

### 9.2 Constraints

- **C1:** Limited engineering bandwidth — measurement and onboarding work competes with the global roadmap.
- **C2:** Music licensing restrictions — regional catalogue depth depends on label agreements outside this project.
- **C3:** Strong competition from bundled telecom services (JioSaavn) and free video platforms (YouTube).
- **C4:** Budget limitation of \$80,000 for the discovery-and-definition phase (Section 13).
- **C5:** Dependency on recommendation model improvements owned by the global personalisation team.
- **C6:** Device & network floor — must work on entry-level Android hardware and inconsistent 4G networks.

## 10. Success Criteria & KPIs

## 10.1 Business Goal & Primary KPI

### PRIMARY KPI — AVERAGE LISTENING MINUTES PER MAU

Current: 35 minutes/day (assumed baseline) → Target: 50 minutes/day within 6 months of solution rollout. This single metric is the north star: every requirement, driver metric, and business outcome in this document ladders up to it.

## 10.2 Supporting KPIs

| KPI                        | Current | Target | KPI Tree Branch             |
|----------------------------|---------|--------|-----------------------------|
| Daily listening time / MAU | 35 min  | 50 min | North star                  |
| Average session duration   | 18 min  | 25 min | Session duration            |
| Playlist completion rate   | 52%     | 70%    | Session duration            |
| Skip rate                  | 30%     | 20%    | Session duration            |
| DAU/MAU ratio              | 42%     | 50%    | Session frequency           |
| Premium conversion         | 4%      | 6%     | Monetisation                |
| 30-day retention           | 58%     | 68%    | Monetisation / Active users |

Success KPIs — Current Baseline vs 6-Month Target

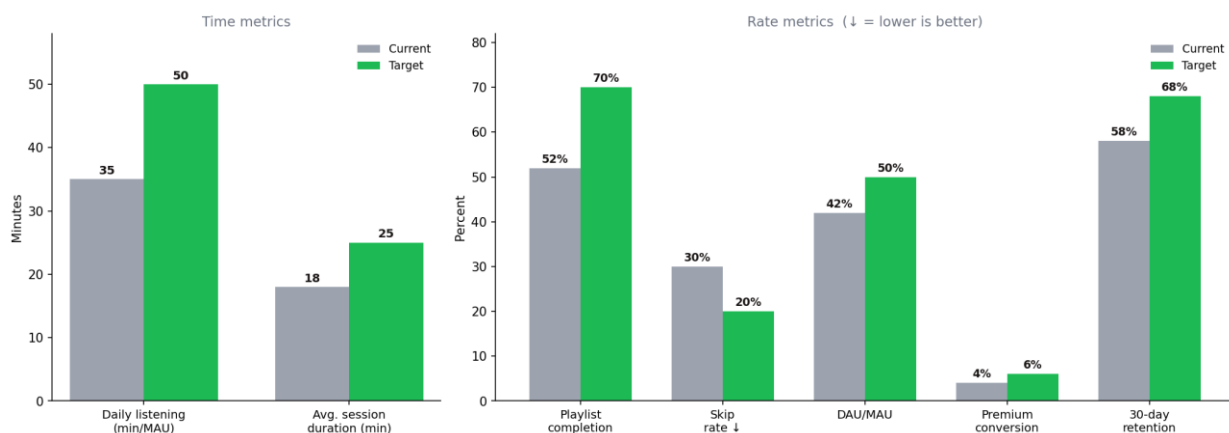


Figure 10 — Baseline vs 6-month targets across all success KPIs (baselines assumed for project planning).

## 10.3 KPI Tree

The KPI tree decomposes the north-star goal into four controllable branches — active users, session frequency, session duration, and monetisation — each measured by specific metrics. Read top-down for strategy and bottom-up for reporting.



Figure 11 — KPI tree linking the listening-time goal to its levers, metrics, and the business outcomes it unlocks.

## 10.4 Guardrail Metrics

- Premium conversion rate must not decline while Free-tier engagement grows.
- NPS / CSAT and uninstall rate must not degrade.
- Ad-load complaints must stay within current thresholds.
- Default data consumption per listening hour must not increase.

## 11. Timeline & Milestones

| Week   | Milestone               | Key Output                                                          |
|--------|-------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Week 1 | User research           | Interviews & diary studies across metro and Tier 2/3 users          |
| Week 2 | Competitor benchmarking | Engagement-model comparison: YouTube Music, JioSaavn, Amazon, Apple |
| Week 3 | User journey mapping    | Current vs proposed journeys validated with research                |
| Week 4 | BRD draft completion    | This document circulated to all stakeholders                        |
| Week 5 | Analytics validation    | Assumed baselines replaced with production data; KPI dashboard live |
| Week 6 | Stakeholder review      | Design, Engineering, Data, Marketing sign-off                       |
| Week 7 | Final BRD approval      | Leadership approval; hand-off to solution design                    |

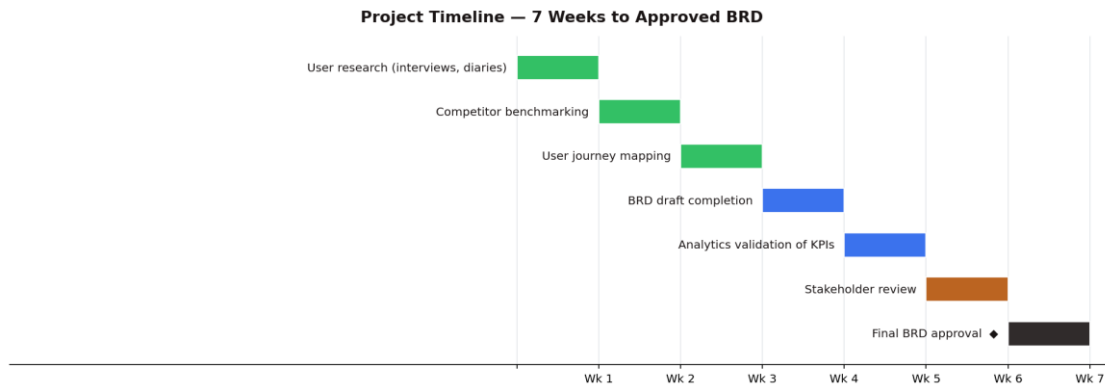


Figure 12 — Seven-week path from research to approved BRD.

## 12. Stakeholders

| Stakeholder           | Responsibility                                        | RACI                |
|-----------------------|-------------------------------------------------------|---------------------|
| Product Manager       | Project owner; drives the BRD and go/no-go gate       | Accountable         |
| Business Analyst      | Requirements gathering; owns this document            | Responsible         |
| UX Research Team      | User interviews, diary studies, journey mapping       | Responsible         |
| Data Analytics Team   | KPI measurement, baseline validation, dashboarding    | Responsible         |
| Data Engineering      | Data pipelines for engagement tracking                | Consulted           |
| Engineering Team      | Feasibility input; future feature implementation      | Consulted           |
| Design Team           | UI/UX improvements in solution phase                  | Consulted           |
| Marketing Team        | User engagement campaigns; acquisition-cohort context | Consulted           |
| Regional Partnerships | Music catalogue expansion context                     | Consulted           |
| Leadership Team       | Final approval                                        | Informed / Approver |

## 13. Cost & Benefit

### 13.1 Estimated Costs (Discovery & Definition Phase)

| Activity      | Estimated Cost | Covers                                                           |
|---------------|----------------|------------------------------------------------------------------|
| User Research | \$20,000       | Multilingual interviews, diary studies, field travel, incentives |
| Analytics     | \$15,000       | Baseline validation, segmentation, KPI dashboard build           |
| Design        | \$10,000       | Journey mapping, persona development, workshop facilitation      |
| Engineering   | \$30,000       | Instrumentation for FR-1 to FR-10, experiment framework          |
| Testing       | \$5,000        | Data-quality validation, dashboard UAT                           |

| Activity | Estimated Cost | Covers |
|----------|----------------|--------|
| Total    | \$80,000       | —      |

## 13.2 Expected Benefits

- 10–15% increase in listening time within 6 months of solution rollout (path to the 35 → 50 min goal).
- 5–7% relative increase in Premium subscriptions (supporting the 4% → 6% conversion target).
- Higher advertising revenue: listening minutes are ad inventory, so Free-tier minute growth expands sellable impressions roughly proportionally.
- Improved customer retention (58% → 68% at 30 days) and higher customer lifetime value.
- Increased market share in India as engagement depth becomes the differentiator against bundled rivals.

**Break-even logic:** *at India's scale, even a fraction of a percentage point of sustained conversion or retention improvement recovers the \$80,000 discovery cost many times over. A full LTV model will be produced by Finance after Week-5 baseline validation.*

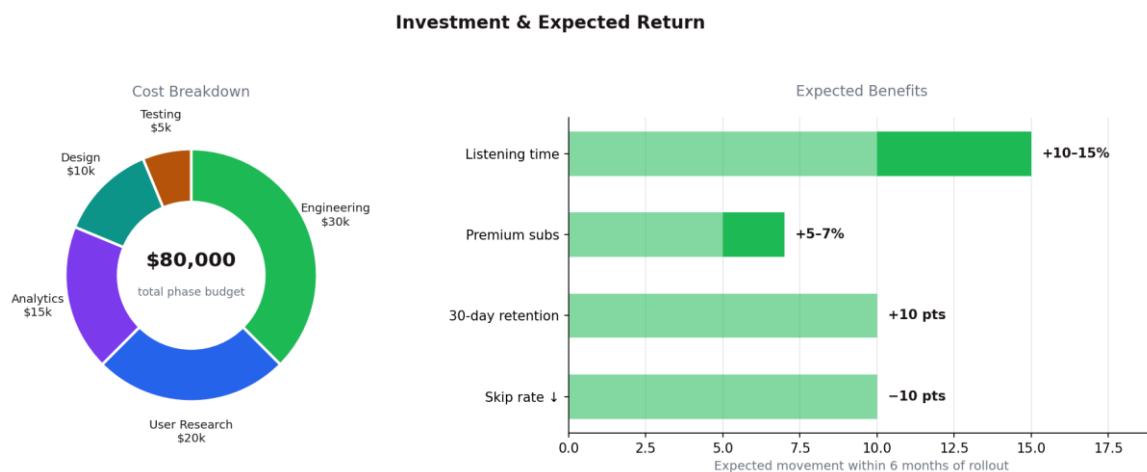


Figure 13 — \$80,000 phase investment against the expected six-month returns.

## 14. Glossary

| Term          | Meaning                                                                            |
|---------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| MAU / DAU     | Monthly / Daily Active Users                                                       |
| DAU/MAU ratio | Share of monthly users active on a given day; measures habit strength (stickiness) |
| ARPU          | Average Revenue Per User                                                           |
| LTV           | Customer Lifetime Value                                                            |
| Churn         | Percentage of users who stop using the service                                     |

| Term                | Meaning                                                                                |
|---------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Session duration    | Time spent in one continuous listening session                                         |
| Skip rate           | Percentage of songs skipped (especially within the first 30 seconds)                   |
| Playlist completion | Percentage of playlists listened to completely                                         |
| Engagement          | Total interaction with Spotify features — listening, saving, sharing, following        |
| KPI tree            | Hierarchical map linking driver metrics to the north-star metric and business outcomes |
| Guardrail metric    | A metric that must not degrade while the target metric is improved                     |
| DPDP Act            | India's Digital Personal Data Protection Act, 2023                                     |
| Tier 2/3 cities     | Smaller Indian cities and towns beyond the major metros                                |

## 15. References

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- Spotify Annual Reports and Quarterly Earnings Reports
- Deloitte Digital Media Report; PwC Entertainment & Media Outlook (India); FICCI-EY Media & Entertainment Report
- Google Play Store and Apple App Store review analysis (Spotify India)
- Industry competitor analysis: YouTube Music, JioSaavn, Gaana, Amazon Music, Apple Music
- Market events: Wynk Music shutdown & Apple Music migration (2024); Gaana's paid-only transition; Spotify India launch (Feb 2019)
- Milestone 1 research pack: Indian streaming market analysis, Spotify UX audit, competitor benchmark, engagement-metric rationale

## 16. Appendix

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### A. User Segmentation

Users are segmented on two axes that matter most for engagement in India — geography (metro vs Tier 2/3 & rural) and monetisation tier (free vs premium). This locates where the largest listening-time headroom sits and which personas represent each quadrant.

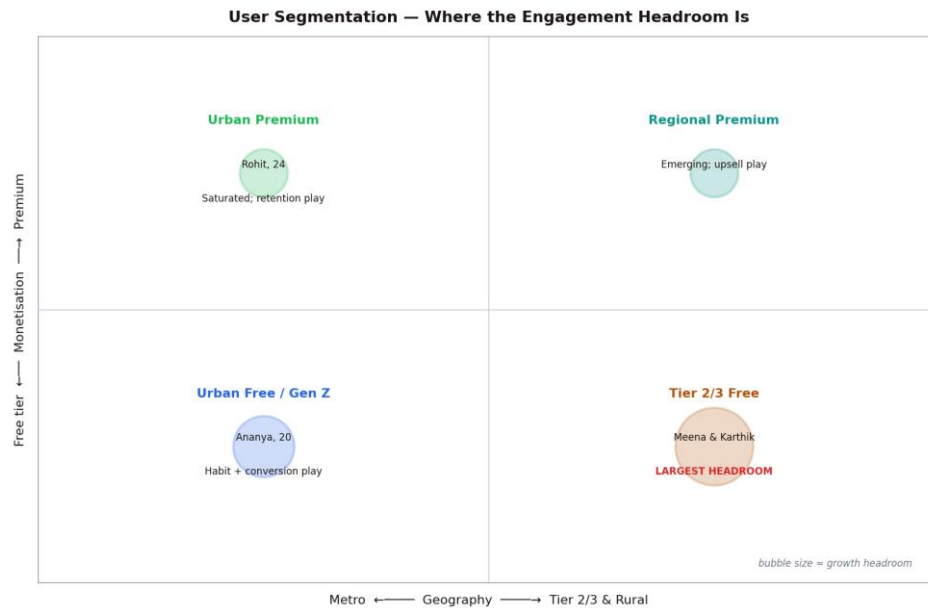


Figure 14 — Segmentation matrix. The Tier 2/3 free quadrant holds the largest untapped listening-time headroom.

## B. User Personas

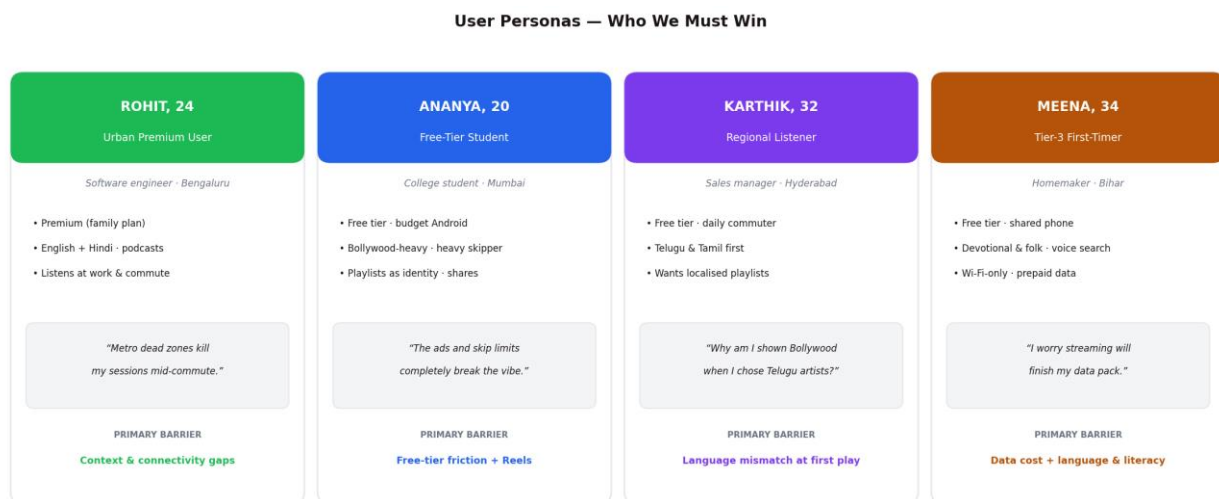


Figure 15 — The four personas this initiative must win, each with a distinct primary barrier.

| Attribute        | Persona 1 — Urban Premium User                     | Persona 2 — Free-Tier Student                             | Persona 3 — Regional Language Listener                 | Persona 4 — Tier 3 First-Time Streamer                      |
|------------------|----------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------|
| Profile          | Rohit, 24 — Software Engineer, Bengaluru           | Ananya, 20 — College student, Mumbai                      | Karthik, 32 — Sales manager, Hyderabad                 | Meena, 34 — Homemaker, Bihar                                |
| Plan & device    | Premium (family plan); mid-range Android + desktop | Free tier; budget Android; hostel Wi-Fi                   | Free tier; Android; commutes daily                     | Free tier; shared family Android; prepaid data              |
| Listening habits | Listens during work and commute; English + Hindi   | Bollywood-heavy; frequent skipper; playlists as identity; | Prefers Telugu & Tamil music; listens while commuting; | Devotional, folk & film songs; voice-search reliant; Wi-Fi- |

| Attribute               | Persona 1 — Urban Premium User                                    | Persona 2 — Free-Tier Student                                   | Persona 3 — Regional Language Listener                             | Persona 4 — Tier 3 First-Time Streamer                             |
|-------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------|
|                         | playlists; podcasts                                               | shares to Instagram                                             | wants localised playlists                                          | only streaming                                                     |
| Key frustration         | Recommendations drift from context; metro dead zones cut sessions | Ads and skip limits break the vibe; leaves after advertisements | Receives Bollywood/English content instead of Telugu at first play | English-heavy UI; fears data charges; kids' songs pollute her feed |
| What success looks like | Seamless all-day companion across work and commute                | Free tier engaging enough to build a daily habit                | Home page in his language from session one                         | Confident, low-data listening without struggle or risk             |

### C. What 'Success' Looks Like (Problem-Framed, Not Prescriptive)

Described as observable user outcomes rather than a prescribed flow — any solution that produces these signals counts as success:

- A regional-language user reaches relevant content quickly at first play (however that is achieved).
- Sessions extend and playlists are completed more often, because content stays relevant.
- Listening recurs daily around stable contexts (commute, study, wind-down) — a habit forms.
- Engaged users convert to Premium at a higher rate, because value is felt before it is paid for.

*The mechanism to reach each outcome is intentionally left open for the solution phase.*

### D. Hypothesis Backlog (Excerpt — to be validated in Weeks 1–5)

| ID | Hypothesis (We believe... we will know when...)                                                                                                            | Linked FR   |
|----|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------|
| H1 | Free-tier skip/shuffle limits materially shorten student sessions; true if limit-hitting users' sessions are $\geq 20\%$ shorter than matched non-hitters. | FR-5        |
| H2 | Language mismatch at first play drives early exits; true if language-matched first sessions run significantly longer than mismatched ones.                 | FR-6, FR-11 |
| H3 | Data-cost anxiety restricts Tier 2/3 streaming to Wi-Fi; true if $\geq 40\%$ report Wi-Fi-only behaviour and mobile-data sessions are shorter.             | FR-3, FR-7  |
| H4 | Ad breaks are the most common Free-tier session-exit trigger; true if exit events cluster within 60 seconds of ad playback.                                | FR-3        |
| H5 | Commute windows hold the largest habit-forming potential; true if intraday listening curves confirm concentration in 8–10 am and 6–8 pm slots.             | FR-2        |

— End of Document —